

1 Rivers

2

KNOWLEDGE FOCUS

You will answer questions on:

- 1.1 The main hydrological characteristics and processes which operate in rivers and drainage basins
- 1.2 The main landforms associated with these processes
- 1.3 Rivers present opportunities and hazards for people

EXAM SKILLS FOCUS

In this topic you will:

- show that you understand what command words are
- show that you understand the command word 'explain' and answer an 'explain' question
- show that you understand the command word 'compare' and answer a 'compare' question.

Command words form the foundation for any assessment question. They are not specific to geography. Instead, they are instructions, such as 'explain' or 'compare'. While command words do not specify

which topics to write about, they do guide you on how to approach a particular question. Each topic of this book will contain questions using at least two different command words, to allow you to practise.

The command word 'explain' means to set out purposes or reasons / make the relationships between things clear / say why and/or how and support with relevant evidence. This means you should say why or how something happens. 'Explain' questions assess your understanding of geographical systems, theories and processes. This type of question is common in geography exams and can feature in all three papers.

The command word 'compare' means to identify/comment on similarities and/or differences. Comparison questions require you to focus on two or more different features or concepts, recognising what they have in common and how they differ from one another. Key words such as 'both', 'however', 'similarly' and 'in contrast' are useful for these types of questions.